

The Boston Globe

Serving our community since 1872

FRIDAY, NOVEMBER 14, 2025

Lexington schools sued over LGBTQ+ material

Parent wants child excused in test of Supreme Court ruling

By Katie Muchnick
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

In a test of a recent Supreme Court ruling, a parent is suing Lexington Public Schools to have his child excused from LGBTQ+-themed instruction and readings that he claims violate his religious beliefs.

The suit, filed on Oct. 17 in US District Court, comes on the heels

of a Supreme Court decision that held parents have the right to opt out of lessons featuring LGBTQ+-themed storybooks if they go against their religious beliefs.

“We do think that this poses that kind of same direct threat to the parent’s ability to instill his religious beliefs in his child,” said Sam Whiting, a lawyer from the Massachusetts Family Institute represent-

ing the Lexington parent. “We’re surprised that the school district has not been more accommodating in light of that precedent, because we feel that Supreme Court case is just so similar on the facts to this case.”

A lawyer for Lexington schools said the Supreme Court’s decision creates a new obligation for public schools that officials are still figur-

ing out how to implement. He denied the district stalled on fulfilling the parent’s request to remove his child from those instructions, adding that deciding which curriculum materials violate a parents’ religious beliefs can be labor intensive and that the district worked “diligently” to address parent concerns.

“Lexington, as well as other schools, are struggling with respecting the decision and respecting the

LGBTQ+, Page A9

Deal saves health care access for 200,000

UMass Memorial Health, Blue Cross Blue Shield reach three-year pact

By Jessica Bartlett
GLOBE STAFF

UMass Memorial Health and Blue Cross Blue Shield of Massachusetts have reached an agreement on a new contract, preserving health care access for nearly 200,000 people.

Though the sides declined to specify any details of their new three-year agreement, the deal brings to an end a weeks-long public dispute, keeping Central Massachusetts’ largest medical provider in the network for the state’s largest health insurer.

“I’m so pleased that, working together, our organizations have reached an agreement that maintains coverage without disruption,” said Blue Cross Blue Shield CEO and president Sarah Iselin, in a statement. “Our company looks forward to partnering with UMass to provide access to affordable, quality and equitable care in the years ahead.”

Dr. Eric Dickson, chief executive of UMass Memorial Health, said in a statement that as health systems face increasing challenges, those that serve underserved populations would need addi-

CONTRACT, Page A8

EVERY LITTLE BIT COUNTS WHEN STRETCHING FOOD AID



SUZANNE KREITER/GLOBE STAFF

Orlando Rivera Jr. sang “Happy Birthday” to his son, Daniel Librado Rivera, on his 10th birthday. A neighbor donated the cake.

By Mara Kardas-Nelson
GLOBE STAFF

It was 8 a.m., and Renée Dingman, 40, grabbed a slice of toasted Portuguese sweet-bread before ushering her 13-year-old son, Jamari, into the car for school. As her 2004 Acura kicked up red, orange, and yellow leaves, Dingman mentally planned the family’s meals.

Jamari gets breakfast and lunch at school and spends weekends at his dad’s. On Saturday, Dingman would use her employee discount to buy a half-priced burger at the 99, where she pulls 12-hour shifts cooking.

For so many in need, SNAP benefits are a crucial factor in the daily calculations of getting enough to eat

But it was only Wednesday. She needed fruit — Jamari’s favorite — and other groceries to get through the week.

Dingman receives \$50 a month in food assistance from the federal government, through the Supplemental Nutrition Assistance Program, or SNAP. By the time the US Department of Agriculture announced that SNAP benefits for November would not be released because of the government shutdown, that \$50 from the previous month was long gone.

Although the record-breaking shutdown,

SNAP, Page A9

Democrats hopeful but realistic about GOP help on health subsidies

By Mary Clare Jalonick
ASSOCIATED PRESS

WASHINGTON — Now that the government shutdown is over, House and Senate Republicans say they will negotiate with Democrats on whether to extend COVID-era tax credits that help tens of millions of Americans afford their health care premiums. But finding bipartisan agreement could be difficult, if not impossible, before the subsidies expire at the end of the year.

The shutdown ended this week after a small group of Democrats made a deal

with Republican senators who promised a vote by mid-December on extending the Affordable Care Act subsidies. But there is no guaranteed outcome, and many Republicans have made clear they want the credits to expire.

House Speaker Mike Johnson, Republican of Louisiana, called the subsidies a “boondoggle” immediately after the House voted Wednesday to end the shutdown, and President Trump said the Obama-era health overhaul was a “disaster” as he signed the reopening

HEALTH CARE VOTE, Page A6

The bright stuff

Friday: Sunnier, pleasant. High 44-49. Low 31-36.

Saturday: Rain late. High 43-48. Low 36-41.

Sunrise: 6:34 Sunset: 4:23

Weather and Comics, G6-7.

VOL. 308, NO. 137

*

Suggested retail price
\$4.00



The Patriots kept their winning streak alive, beating the Jets, 27-14, for their eighth straight victory. **C1.**

In emails, Jeffrey Epstein focused intently on Donald Trump for years, seeking to exploit the remnants of their relationship. **A2.**

With so many students getting A's, Harvard administrators are telling professors to be less lenient. **B5.**

A baby alligator was rescued after being found in the chilly Charles River. **B1.**

BU student says he called ICE ‘for months’ before raid at car wash

By Camilo Fonseca
GLOBE STAFF
and Truman Dickerson
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

The president of the Boston University College Republicans appeared to claim credit for an immigration raid on a car wash in Allston in which nine workers were detained, saying in a social media post that he had been “calling ICE for months on end” to “detain these criminals.”

Zachary Segal, president of the university’s GOP student chapter, made the comment in a post on X on Nov. 7, above a Boston.com article about the raid.

“This week they finally responded to my request,” Segal wrote. “As someone who lives in the neighborhood, I’ve seen how American jobs are being given away to those with no right to be here.”

“Pump up the numbers!” he added. An ICE spokesperson declined to comment on Segal’s claim or say whether his calls led to the raid.

ICE, Page A8



LANE TURNER/GLOBE STAFF

Co-workers and immigration advocates said many of the car wash workers had legal status.

WRAP UP
A GREAT RATE
THIS SEASON.

4.01%
APY*
9-MONTH CD OR IRA CD SPECIAL



End the year on a high note. Take advantage of this strong rate now.

Other terms are available. To open your new CD, visit any Salem Five branch location or visit saalemfive.com/wrap

SalemFive
MAKE YOUR MOVE.™

*Annual Percentage Yield (APY) is accurate as of 11/4/2025 and subject to change. A minimum balance of \$10,000 is required to open and obtain the annual percentage yield (APY) for our non-IRA CD Special, and for our IRA CD Special the minimum balance is \$2,000. A penalty will be imposed for early withdrawals from Certificates of Deposit (CDs). Maximum deposit amount is \$500,000. Fees may reduce earnings. Personal accounts only. One account per customer. Offer good for MA, NH and RI residents only. Salem Five Bank is a Member of the FDIC.